

MAL CFO FOUNDING CIRCLE

Executive One-Pager · Internal Use Only · Co-hosted with Bluefive Capital

PURPOSE

Acquire **80 SME CFOs** as signed Mal customers before official launch by recruiting them as **Founding Members** who co-create the product — not as attendees who watch a demo. Every CFO who walks in should walk out on the waitlist, with their company on a path to banking with Mal.

"We're selecting 80 CFOs to shape the future of SME finance in the GCC. You're one of them."

THE NARRATIVE

The problem: CFOs at UAE SMEs are duct-taping 10 tools together — one for banking, one for payroll, one for invoicing, one for compliance. Their bank doesn't know their business. When they need credit, they fill forms and wait days. If they want Sharia compliance, they compromise on technology.

The villain: Legacy banks that treat every SME the same and force CFOs into systems designed for corporates or consumers — never for them.

The shift: Mal is the first Islamic-native, all-in-one SME operating system. Banking + credit + payroll + compliance + AI — one platform that already knows your business. No other player in the GCC has built this.

The hook: We don't launch Mal at CFOs. We launch it *with* them. 80 hand-selected CFOs get Founding Member status, co-design input, and their name attached to infrastructure 10,000 businesses will use. This is recognition, not a sales pitch.

The flywheel: Each CFO signs their company → their employees get Mal personal accounts (retail bridge) → they refer peers to the community → the community grows the product → the product grows Mal.

THE STRATEGY

- 1

5 Cohorts, Not 1 Conference
80 CFOs split into 5 groups of 16, by sector. One cohort every 2 weeks over 10 weeks (Aug–Oct). Intimate sessions convert; conferences don't.
- 2

Pre-Qualify Every Invite
No awareness attendees. Every CFO is screened for a real pain point Mal solves (AED 5M–500M revenue, 10–500 employees, UAE ops). 120 names sourced, 80 invited.
- 3

Convert in the Room
Crisis Simulation using Mal tools → hands-on product experience. iPads at every seat. Live "Founding CFOs" wall fills in real time. Social proof + zero friction = sign-up.
- 4

E-Invoicing as the Urgency Lever
UAE e-invoicing mandate hits SMEs by July 2027. Position Mal as "compliance + financing in one platform." Fear of penalties accelerates decisions.
- 5

Content Engine Warms the Funnel
5-episode "Mal Show" podcast (ft. Youssef Salem, ADNOC Drilling CFO) drops weekly through August. Every episode ends with a waitlist CTA. Every guest gets a Founding Circle invite.
- 6

Lock In Long-Term via Community
CFO Advisory Council (10–15 seats, design partners). Startup Grant Program (USD 10–15K/quarter, zero cost to Mal via Hub71/Bluefive). Quarterly dinners. This is a membership, not a one-off event.

KPIS THAT MATTER

80 FOUNDING CFOS SIGNED ACROSS 5 COHORTS	90%+ WAITLIST SIGN-UP RATE PER SESSION	10–15 ADVISORY COUNCIL SEATS FILLED
5–8 DESIGN PARTNERSHIPS SIGNED	60%+ FOUNDING CFOS → ACTIVE ACCOUNTS WITHIN 90 DAYS	4,000+ RETAIL ACCOUNTS VIA PAYROLL BRIDGE (EMPLOYEES)